# Locative narratives: an open access to the renewal of place and self

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Locative narratives constitute one of the genres of electronic literary creation that extend beyond the screen . They represent one of the most indicative examples of the expansion and renewal of digital storytelling, facilitated by digital media, particularly locative media, which create an hybrid interaction between the real and the virtual (Psarras, 15/12/2008). Through locative narratives, a new way of perceiving and mapping lived and narrative experience emerges, with the reader–user–walker being physically situated within the surrounding natural and digital world, as well as within the narrative construct that unfolds, and is transformed into an interactive performer who determines the realization of the work (Rettberg 2019: 185). This particular hybrid form of electronic literary creation attracts an increasing number of creators worldwide. But what is its place within the literary production of countries that are underrepresented on the international map of literary electronic production with just an emerging engagement with the field of Digital Humanities, such as the Modern Greek digital literary creation and critics? This proposal will focus on a recent locative creation in the context of contemporary Greek literary production (2021-2022): Ismini Gatos' america 2 ( https://explore.echoes.xyz/collections/HwhVY6EJZ2cJIJbu ), supported by the Echoes Explorer app. America 2 is a sound-based locative walking project centered around Amerikis Square, exploring how thirteen subjects—residents of the area—relate to this specific public, shared, and "open" place. Through an inclusive and participatory approach, the project generates thirteen moving digital narratives resembling conversations, personal sound diaries, voice recordings made while walking alone in public spaces (voice

notes), as well as other non-verbal creative practices. In other words, thirteen persons use multimedia tools and share their personal stories, which become part of a larger cultural narrative for this central neighborhood of Athens. This presentation will attempt to highlight the process of reader-use's engagement with the work, as a way of redefining our identity in relation to the surrounding world, and more specifically, the urban space, based on dominant notions that technotropically and hermeneutically shape the majority of digitally supported literary creations. The analysis of america 2 will be based, firstly, on the terms of spatiality and temporality , given that digital locative media phenomenologically redefine the perception of the there of being , as the user constantly oscillates between the physical surrounding space, with its material/architectural and historical elements- what J. High refers to as narrative archaeology (High 2006:3-5)- and the event unfolding during the digital representation of the narrative on the screen. The user transforms into a modern flâneur , embedded in today's urban and digital landscape, into an orchestrator of steps, rhythms, relations, states, and digital data (Psarras, 15/12/2018). Evidently, the user's body plays also a dominant role. As they embodilly navigate the predetermined by the creator city streets, they receive visual and auditory stimuli from the surrounding environment and can also touch what draws up their attention. At the same time, however, they witness their digital presence , they are immersed in the digital spatial field of the application, they can choose -with a sense of tangibility - among material data, while their headphones (hardware) deliver the unfolding narratives. Space, time and body, in physical or digital terms, compose the locative narratives; a digital genre that can recontextualize the relationship of any user with

the local environment and also with themselves.

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